

Stampede For Used Laptops

Nearly 5,500 people had gathered to buy 1,000 used laptops for \$50 (Rs 2,200) in Richmond, Virginia in the US on August 16. When the shop opened, a stampede ensued—someone tried to drive a car through the crowd, and an elderly man was thrown to the pavement.



Gadget Can 'Cure' Cellulite

A gadget that removes cellulite has been a success in the US. The gadget works by using infra-red light to break up the fat that causes the cellulite. The Syneron Vela-Smooth then gives a deep massage, followed by a suction action. The treatment costs £80 (Rs 6,300) per session.



Escape

WE ARE NOT AMUSED

Google's Chief Gets Googled

To use a stock phrase, it's a delicious irony. Google's chief executive Eric E Schmidt is miffed at the fact that CNETNews.com published personal details about him—details that became available through a Google search.

In the first week of August, Google told CNETNews.com, a technology news Web site, that they would not answer any questions from CNET's reporters until July 2006. This move came after CNET published an article in July that discussed how Google can uncover personal information, and which raised questions about what information Google collects about its users.

The article, by Elinor Mills, a CNET staff writer, gave several examples of information about Google's chief executive Schmidt, which could be gleaned



from the search engine. These included that his shares in Google were worth \$1.5 billion (almost Rs 6,525 crore), that he lived in Atherton, California, that he had been a fund-raiser for Al Gore's presidential campaign, and that he was a pilot.

After the article appeared, David Krane,

Google's director of public relations, called CNET editors to complain, said Jai Singh, the editor-in-chief of CNETNews.com.

"They were unhappy about the fact that we used Schmidt's private information in our story," Singh said.

He added, "Our view is what we published was all public information, and we actually used their own product to find it." Singh also said Mr Krane called back to say that Google would not speak to any reporter from CNET for a year.

Singh, who has worked in technology news for more than two decades, said he could not recall a similar situation. "Sometimes a company is ticked off and won't talk to a reporter for a bit," he said, "but I've never seen a company not talk to a whole news organisation."

UNUSABLE!

Nokia CDMA 2112

Ah! Those ubiquitous devices that all of us draw out of our pockets like gunslingers and shoot off calls and messages to anywhere in the world... but wait! It's not always that simple—especially if you're using the Reliance IndiaMobile service in India.

We took a look at a Nokia (yes, the same reliable, easy-to-use Nokia) model—the 2112 CDMA—available from Reliance, and tried to send an SMS. Here are the steps involved:

Menu > Messages > Text Messages > Create Message > Add Number > [Number selected] > Options > [Option 4] Edit Message > Type Message > Options > Send.

Whew! But there's another way too... scroll down to the number you want to send the message to and then:

Options > [Option 13] Send Message > [Type Message] > Send. That's roughly 11 (or about five) steps to send a message. Actually it's 15 (or 18) if you count having to scroll to choose 'Edit Message', but we will be nice!

Now, we wonder why Nokia went ahead and messed around with a perfectly good, fast, intuitive and easy-to-use menu system and created this monster. Or was it Reliance's doing?

Most other Nokia phones (read GSM) allow three-step access to the message window (and just one step in some of the new Symbian 60 phones). Whoever the culprit, the menu system is just terrible!



Win!

My Desktop

Think you have the most beautiful, most innovative desktop around? E-mail with subject '**My Desktop**' and your postal address to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com, and Digit will publish the most eye-catching of them each month.

Next month's winner will receive **EA Cricket 2004 Game**



There is no winner for this month. The majority of entries we received used desktop theme packs. This is not allowed!